Vice Senior General Maung Aye went to Mandalay and prostrated himself in front of the Head Abbot, apologizing for the behaviour of the troops and that took the wind out of the sails of the protestors. By the third week of September, normalcy had returned somewhat, the monks' feelings were assuaged and the people had come to terms with the new pricing on fuel. There was one positive fallout as far as we were concerned. Veena had applied to a number of schools, even given some interviews and done some substitution work, but there were no vacancies. Some Westerners were expelled by the junta for participating in the protests, which included a couple of teachers. The schools were in a bind, as the junta was not inclined to give visas to any more Westerners, so Veena was offered a full-time job at the Myanmar International Educational Services School (MIES), Yangon.

Amala, in the meantime, had joined the International School, Yangon (ISY), a private, co-educational day school, for students of all nationalities, based on the US system. The school was founded in 1955 and was widely considered to be the most prestigious secondary school in Myanmar. The school year begins in the second week of August, so we had reached just in time to complete all the admission formalities. Although the school operates as a private school entity in Myanmar, it did so under the umbrella of the American Embassy, receiving some subsidies through the US State Department. Fortunately for Amala, she did not lose a year due to this change of system, though it was touch and go for some time, while the equivalence of credits was worked out. In the US system, there are no streams as such and all students have to do English, maths, a secondary language (French, which Amala had taken in India), any one of the sciences (physics, chemistry or biology), one of the life sciences (economics, history, geography, et al.) and the

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